

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



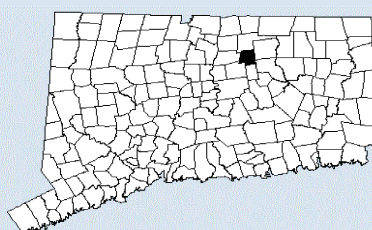
Vernon School District

Joseph Macary, Superintendent • 860-870-6000 • <https://www.vernonpublicschools.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	11
Enrollment	3,226
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$19,042
Total Expenditures ¹	\$65,027,993

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

Contents

Students.....	1
Educators.....	2
Instruction and Resources.....	2
Performance and Accountability.....	4
Narratives.....	7

Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.3
Male	1,647	51.1	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.2
Asian	233	7.2	5.2
Black or African American	325	10.1	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	769	23.8	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	283	8.8	4.7
White	1,614	50.0	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	121	3.8	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,755	54.4	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	621	19.2	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	105	6.4
Male	253	16.1	154	8.8
Non-Binary	*	*	0	*
Black or African American	54	16.5	53	14.4
Hispanic or Latino of any race	160	21.8	83	10.0
White	158	10.4	92	5.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	26	20.2	9	6.4
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	376	22.4	216	10.9
Students with Disabilities	146	26.2	90	12.6
District	477	15.6	259	7.6
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 437

Number of school-based arrests: Fewer than 6

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Vernon School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	246.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	27.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	37.3
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	125.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	10.0
School Level	12.5
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	0.0
Support Staff	5.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	11.2
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	28.0
School Nurses	8.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	171.1

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	1	0.3	0.1
Asian	5	1.5	1.4
Black or African American	4	1.2	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	12	3.5	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	2	0.6	0.1
Two or More Races	1	0.3	0.3
White	320	92.8	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	9.7	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	35	94.6	29	100.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	44	100.0	44	97.8
White	137	97.2	139	99.3
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	113	97.4	116	100.0
Students with Disabilities	41	95.3	37	94.9
District	250	97.7	242	99.2
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	49	51.6
Emotional Disability	10	28.6
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	149	76.0
Other Health Impairment	89	64.5
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	51	92.7
District	361	63.9
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Vernon School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	100	3.1	2.6
Emotional Disability	35	1.1	1.1
Intellectual Disability	29	0.9	0.6
Learning Disability	196	6.1	6.4
Other Health Impairment	139	4.3	3.5
Other Disabilities	38	1.2	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	72	2.2	2.0
All Disabilities	609	18.8	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	51	8.4	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	14	2.3	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$37,732,109	\$11,049	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$7,311,032	\$2,331	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$3,189,256	\$1,017	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$2,873,193	\$916	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$3,015,130	\$961	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$698,369	\$223	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$6,547,700	\$2,087	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$3,119,255	\$1,292	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	\$541,949	\$173	\$213
Total	\$65,027,993	\$19,042	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$3,003,373	17.6	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$2,374,964	13.9	10.2
Other Salaries	\$3,256,803	19.1	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$2,420,497	14.2	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$534,520	3.1	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$3,843,563	22.5	22.2
Supplies	\$58,813	0.3	0.7
Property Services	.	.	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$1,569,189	9.2	8.4
Equipment	\$1,873	0.0	0.3
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$17,063,595	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		26.2	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	56.8
State	35.2
Federal	6.5
Tuition & Other	1.5

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Vernon School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Asian	92	73.4	92	72.5	*	*
Black or African American	151	62.8	151	55.8	76	56.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	363	61.7	362	55.7	152	57.9
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	*	*
Two or More Races	137	63.1	137	58.7	53	61.6
White	778	69.3	776	65.6	359	68.4
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	90	64.8	89	63.5	31	61.7
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	1,433	66.6	1,431	62.0	649	64.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	795	61.7	792	56.7	336	59.6
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	728	71.8	728	67.9	344	68.7
Students with Disabilities	290	45.3	289	39.5	119	44.8
Students without Disabilities	1,233	71.5	1,231	67.4	561	68.3
High Needs	909	61.0	906	56.1	387	58.7
Non-High Needs	614	74.7	614	70.9	293	71.5
District	1,523	66.5	1,520	62.1	680	64.2

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at

https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	85.0	81.9	81.4	91.5	939	84.9
Curl Up	83.8	82.6	82.2	86.5	936	83.8
Push Up	81.4	67.3	70.2	79.0	939	74.5
Mile Run/PACER	77.3	59.3	61.6	55.6	938	63.8
All Tests - District	62.8	48.7	53.7	52.3	935	54.5
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Vernon School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	27	59.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	49	73.5
White	120	87.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	130	71.5
Students with Disabilities	50	54.0
District	224	81.3
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	137	55.7
Male	*	*
Non-Binary	*	*
Black or African American	19	28.8
Hispanic or Latino	30	33.7
White	160	56.9
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	80	34.5
Students with Disabilities	6	7.3
District	247	49.4
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	72.3	86.1
Male	56.1	79.1
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	43.6	*
White	73.0	88.6
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	49.5	76.1
Students with Disabilities	24.2	*
District	65.5	83.5
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Vernon School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	66.5	75	44.3	50	88.7	63.9
	High Needs Students	61.0	75	40.7	50	81.4	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	62.1	75	41.4	50	82.8	60.2
	High Needs Students	56.1	75	37.4	50	74.8	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	64.2	75	42.8	50	85.6	61.8
	High Needs Students	58.7	75	39.1	50	78.2	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	64.8%	100%	64.8	100	64.8	58.7%
	High Needs Students	61.4%	100%	61.4	100	61.4	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	66.4%	100%	66.4	100	66.4	61.4%
	High Needs Students	62.3%	100%	62.3	100	62.3	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	66.5%	100%	33.2	50	66.5	58.9%
	Oral	58.9%	100%	29.5	50	58.9	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	15.6%	<=5%	28.9	50	57.8	17.7%
	High Needs Students	21.5%	<=5%	17.0	50	33.9	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	98.4%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	49.4%	75%	32.9	50	65.9	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		89.4%	94%	47.6	50	95.1	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		81.3%	94%	86.4	100	86.4	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		70.9%	94%	75.5	100	75.5	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		65.5%	75%	87.3	100	87.3	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		96.6% 54.5%	75%	36.4	50	72.7	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		44.7%	60%	37.2	50	74.5	55.0%
Accountability Index				1062.5	1450	73.3	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	74.7	61.0	13.6	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	70.9	56.1	14.8	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	71.5	58.7	12.9	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	70.9%	23.1%	9.9%	Y

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	98.6
	High Needs Students	98.3
Math	All Students	98.5
	High Needs Students	98.1
Science	All Students	98.1
	High Needs Students	97.4

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 49.0

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Vernon School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Vernon Public Schools believes that the educational programs and services available in the district provide opportunities for the academic, social, and emotional growth of our student population. Our district improvement plan and aligned school improvement plans along with family and community outreach activities highlight our efforts to strengthen student learning outcomes. The District Equity Team meets monthly to discuss strategies to support our students. The District Equity and Engagement Team focused its professional learning on equity and diversity. These efforts are being implemented to help build equitable practices within the district. During the 2023-24 school year, professional learning focused on equity and diversity was provided for teachers and paraeducators. In addition, the District Equity Team participated in multiple learning sessions throughout the year. We also gathered feedback from our students in grades 6-12 regarding equitable practices and to help identify areas for growth.

School-based Attendance Teams work collaboratively with families to identify the root cause of absences, problem-solve and identify proactive strategies to support the student. A mentor program has been established at Vernon Center Middle School to support at-risk students with chronic absenteeism. School staff, including Family Engagement Coordinators, have connected families to community resources such as Cornerstone Foundation, Vernon Social Services, Vernon Youth Services, Hockanum Valley Community Council (HVCC), YMCA, ECHN Family Resource Center, and the Rockville Public Library. The district provides ongoing parent workshops through Peace at Home through live and recorded webinar sessions. The sessions focus on the social, emotional, and behavioral well-being of children (birth through teen). The Ready Set School Fair is an opportunity for families of children ages 3-5 to learn of resources within the community and students entering kindergarten for the fall of 2023 received an activity bag of learning materials. This event was held in May 2024 at Henry Park. Vernon Center Middle School held team family dinners during September and October in place of the traditional open house as an opportunity to connect with families early in the school year. Hopes and Dreams conferences are held in September for school staff and families to connect early in the year to set goals for student success for the year.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Vernon is a diverse community with five elementary schools, one middle school, and one high school. Rockville High School recruits students for Advanced Placement courses, Early College Experience (ECE) courses, and other courses that may garner college credit prior to graduation. All grade 10 and 11 students take the PSAT. A YES team (Youth Empowerment Squad) has been established to provide student voice in addressing the needs of all students within our schools. All students in grades K - 8 engage in the social awareness curriculum which teaches social skills. Students have alternative educational options such as Magnet Schools. ESL programs are offered at several schools. Our website provides many family-friendly functions including a translation feature for non-English speaking families. The district also utilizes phone translation and in-person translation services as needed. Vernon has provided extensive professional learning in curriculum writing and implementation ensuring that all students have access to the same rigorous curriculum and resources. Teachers and paraprofessionals in the district participated in professional opportunities this year to develop a better understanding of diversity and equity. Multicultural events were organized and offered at the building level to help families and students connect with our schools.

Families have been connected to community resources (Cornerstone Foundation and HVCC) to ensure families have access to food and other basic needs. VPS works closely with town departments to ensure families can access resources such as energy assistance and programming for children. In addition, we formed a committee to develop the Vernon Public Schools Increasing Educator Diversity Plan. In our plan, we have identified specific strategies and action steps to recruit, hire, and retain a diverse workforce.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Vernon School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The Vernon Public School district has a common curriculum guaranteed for every student. All curriculum resources are located on the secure staff portal ensuring equitable access among all classrooms. The elementary principals collaboratively plan their budgets to ensure equity among resources. All initiatives are systemic in Vernon, ensuring that each K - 12 student has access to the same rigorous curriculum. Each student shall be given equitable access to education and student technology resources are available at all schools at all grade levels. Community members have access to all communications, media, newsletters, periodicals, advisory services, and representation in actions affecting education in general and the public schools in particular. All Schools have Instructional Leadership Teams which provide input to the principal, assist in the development of the school improvement plan and lead other initiatives in the school. Schools provide portal access to parents and families for the ASPEN Student Information System and distribute monthly newsletters to recognize students and families.